

ion) batteries, plastics, paints, tyres, aluminium, and construction chemicals – just to name a few!

Today, Himadri holds a steadfast focus on automation, AI-driven analytics, and process standardization as part of the evolving global business dynamics in the manufacturing sector, thereby transforming its operations into an automated, data-driven enterprise. Himadri's strategic investments and commitment to environmental responsibility have helped the company to scale new heights, earning coveted recognitions, most recently earning the global standard - Platinum Medal for Sustainability from EcoVadis; The Golden Peacock Award in HR Excellence 2024; 'The Company of the Year' 2024 Award at 'India Chem 2024', along with the 'Three Star Export House Certification' from the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), India.

From being a pioneer in the speciality carbon black production arena to leading the novel innovations in the Energy Storage Systems (ESS) sector, Himadri continues to shape the future of the speciality chemicals and battery materials sector in India and globally, guided by its core values—integrity, respect, and responsibility. The company's achievements are a testament to its long-term vision and commitment to progress.

Q What have been the key technological advancements that have shaped this evolution and propelled Himadri's success on the global stage?

From its inception, Himadri was driven by a bold vision: to harness homegrown technological innovation as the cornerstone of progress. What began in 1990 as a modest coal tar distillation plant in Howrah—initially reliant on manual processes—has evolved into a global leader in the carbon value chain, powered by cutting-edge automation, AI-driven insights, and a relentless pursuit of excellence.

At the heart of this transformation lies Himadri's world-class R&D ecosystem. Comprising 148 professionals, the brightest minds from over a dozen countries—India, China, USA, South Korea, LATAM, and more, including

26 PhDs in the chemical chemistry domain—the team fosters a dynamic cross-cultural exchange of ideas. This global talent pool has cultivated an environment where innovation thrives, which enables the company to optimize production processes, refine existing products, and pioneer groundbreaking solutions that redefine industry standards.

The journey from manual operations to technological leadership has been deliberate. By integrating AI-powered data analytics and precision process simulations across key production lines, Himadri ensures unmatched consistency in output, elevated yields, and enhanced operational efficiency. These advancements have fuelled strategic expansions, with state-of-the-art facilities now spanning Singur, Falta SEZ (West Bengal), Korba (Chhattisgarh), Sambalpur (Odisha), Visakhapatnam (Andhra Pradesh), and China.

Today, Himadri stands at the forefront of innovations across the carbon value chain, delivering premium quality across specialty pitches & oils, commodity & specialty carbon blacks, Sulphonated Naphthalene Formaldehyde (SNF), and more. However, our ambitions stretch further. With a sharp focus on disruptive technologies, we are poised to revolutionize the tyre and battery materials sectors, cementing our role as a catalyst for sustainable industrial progress.

By marrying a legacy of vision with a future-focused mindset, Himadri aims to exemplify how Indian enterprises can lead globally through innovation, adaptability, and an unwavering commitment to excellence.

Q Could you elaborate on the strategic expansions and product diversification initiatives—past, present, and future—that reinforce Himadri's pioneering role in the carbon value chain and how these efforts will sustain its leadership in innovation while driving stakeholder value in India and globally?

Recognizing renewable energy as the cornerstone of a sustainable future, we are addressing one of its most critical gaps: efficient energy storage. Today, cathode—account for almost half of a battery's cost—are

pivotal to this transition. With global lithium-ion battery (LiB) production demanding 9.4 million tonnes of cathode materials annually by 2030, Himadri is rising to the challenge. We aim to produce 200,000 MTPA of Lithium Iron Phosphate (LFP) Cathode Active Material by 2030, sufficient to power 100 GWh of Li-ion batteries in phases over 5–6 years. To catalyze India's self-reliance in energy storage, we are establishing the nation's first commercial LFP Cathode plant, with Phase 1 (40,000 MTPA) operational by Q3FY27.

Our journey has been about working towards mastering the carbon value chain through pioneering products like coal tar pitch, commodity carbon black, and advanced carbon materials. Strategic forward integration enabled us to unlock high-value segments such as Naphthalene and SNF, critical for construction and agrochemical industries. A defining milestone was the development of our specialty pitches for long-range missiles for Defence Research and Development Organisation—a testament to our R&D precision and techno-commercial agility.

Our acquisition of Birla Tyres as a strategic partner, along with Dalmia Bharat Refractories Limited marked our entry into the tyre industry, synergizing our specialty carbon black expertise with automotive demand. Simultaneously, our Haldia Port terminal—a dedicated liquid coal tar pitch facility—has opened doors to global exports, reinforcing our position as a key player in international markets.

Today, we continue to double down on innovation. At Singur, a Brownfield Expansion is underway that will more than double specialty carbon black capacity to create the world's largest single-site facility, catering to surging demand in plastics, coatings, and batteries. In addition, as part of a High-Value Chemical Diversification initiative, we are working on forward integrating our coal tar distillates into anthraquinone (dyes, pigments) and carbazole (pharma, electronics), substituting imports and delivering premium quality for domestic and global industries.

Every strategic move we have made—from entering carbon black to LFP cathode plants—has been driven